

INDIA POLICIES



Version- 3.0
For Internal circulation only
DOP - India

DOP Bench Management Policy- India

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DOP Bench Management Policy India

1. Purpose:

1.1 Our employees are the most valuable assets of the organization. We believe it is important to ensure continuous engagement of employee skills and to provide employees with opportunities to build a successful career path for them.

1.2 This policy articulates the steps to be followed hereafter in the bench management process, provide clarity on the method and lay down the governance mechanism, enabling ease of understanding among all stakeholders.

1.3 Fundamental rider to the BMP:

The employees will continue to be tagged to the process from where they are put “On Bench” throughout their bench period. Their cost and attrition will be tagged to the same process until the employee is formally handed over to the new process.

2. Scope of Bench Management Policy (BMP):

2.1 Following categories of employees would be part of Bench Management Policy (BMP):
Employees at Levels AA to D1 in India.

2.2 Employees who are non-productive and available for redeployment for any of the following reasons only will qualify for BMP:

- i. On Bench due to business reasons (ramp down in business due to closure or any other equivalent)
- ii. On Bench after successful completion of PIP.
- iii. On Bench post a favorable SIR closure.
- iv. On Bench as Training Dropout or Training Failure. This will not include OJT failure. An employee can be on bench due to Training Dropout or Training Failure only once in his/her tenure with DOP.

3. Out of Scope of BMP:

- 3.1 Employees at D2 and above.
- 3.2 Employees on long term leaves including but not limited to ILL, medical, maternity, sabbaticals will not be included in the scope of BMP and will be handled as per applicable policies.
- 3.3 OJT failures (to be handled through the PIP process).
- 3.4 PIP failed/ unsuccessful employees (all such employees will need to be separated directly).
- 3.5 Employees on DTS or are serving notice period.
- 3.6 Employees who are voluntarily absent from scheduled trainings or are awaiting training.
- 3.7 Employees against whom an SIR has been unfavorably closed.
- 3.8 Outlier Management employees (to be handled through the PIP process).
- 3.9 Employees who have been selected for redeployment but awaiting handover into new process.
- 3.10 Employees awaiting BGV clearance for the account/project they are hired for.

4. Bench Methodology and standard guidelines:

- 4.1 The BMP will culminate in either a redeployment opportunity or separation from the organization. Redeployment will be handled by the DOP- WMG Bench Management Team while separation process will be handled as per the current process by the HRBP.
- 4.2 All resources covered under BMP will be considered for redeployment and opportunity explored for allocation of a new process/role basis availability & eligibility and bench team will profile the bench employees against the open ask.
- 4.3 Attendance Incentive will not be paid to the benched employees during the bench period, and they will be eligible for performance linked payouts as applicable in the policy as per the last quarter/ month payout.
- 4.4 The bench pool will be treated as new hire pool and assessed through hiring parameters defined in SOW only.
- 4.5 Between these three stakeholders (employee, current supervisor & HRBP) the following sign offs will be completed before BMP is put into effect:
- 4.6 The employee has shared an email ID & contact number that has been tested on which all further communication.
- 4.7 In case of PIP/ SIR the results are signed off and documented as cleared.

- 4.8 L1 Supervisor initiates bench in the system via My Wipro-> Career-> Employee Movement-> Bench.
- 4.9 Bench letter is auto triggered once the bench is approved in the system by the process/account head.
- 4.10 Sign off with data that the employee is within permissible limit of trainee period.
- 4.11 It is not mandatory for resources to be present physically in office during the BMP. Employees may however be advised at times to present themselves in office and will necessarily need to adhere to the same.
- 4.12 Employees are expected to follow the guidelines defined in **section 6**.
- 4.13 The defined bench period is to be treated as inclusive of “Notice period” and no further notice period will have needed to be served by the employee in case employee is identified for separation. The calculation of notice period will be from bench start date unless there is a non-adherence to any clause described in **section 6**.
- 4.14 The “Notice Period” served during Bench Period, stands nullified once the employee has been able to move out of BMP upon redeployment. For all bench expired cases, HRBP to have one on one with the resource before initiating separation
- 4.15 L1 Supervisor/HRBP to share the Feedback & updates received from respective Spoc with the bench resource.
- 4.16 Any resignation during the bench period will be consistent with the terms and conditions of the existing employment contract.
- 4.17 On completion of Bench Period (Equivalent to applicable Notice Period), the employee will be asked to resign, and separation will be initiated with immediate effect.
- 4.18 During this phase the resource will be available for redeployment and will be on bench and receive salary for the period up to applicable Notice Period
- 4.19 As soon as they are selected for a process their status in the system (My Wipro) will be updated to “awaiting training”.

5. Business Rules:

5.1 On Bench due to Business reasons:

- 5.1.1 Ramp down can be applicable for both new and/or existing processes
- i. Other than normal ramp downs, closures, and reduction in requirements due to business reasons - all other such conditions for business bench will need to be discussed and signed off by the respective BU head and HR partners.
- 5.1.2 Employees who become eligible for “On Bench” due to Business reasons - Bench Period will be equivalent to applicable Notice Period (from ‘On bench’ start date).
- 5.1.3 Following the communication made by HR and Process leader, bench is initiated in the system by the L1 supervisor.
- 5.1.4 Bench letter is auto triggered once the bench is approved in the system by the process/account head.

5.2 On Bench post PIP cleared / SIR closure

- 5.2.1 On Bench post PIP/ SIR successfully cleared (Successfully Cleared would refer to – 1)

members who have cleared the PIP.

5.2.2 SIR cases where the employee is retained in the Organization with or without a warning) will be applicable to all those who have successfully cleared either the PIP or SIR raised against them and the process is unable to accommodate them.

5.2.3 These cases must necessarily have a HR/ Compliance sign off and documentation

5.2.4 For employees who become eligible for “On Bench” due to PIP cleared / SIR closure- Bench period will be equivalent to applicable Notice Period of the concerned employee. (from ‘On bench’ start date)

5.2.5 Following the communication made by HR and L1 supervisor, bench is initiated in the system by the L1 supervisor.

5.2.6 Bench letter is auto triggered once the bench is approved in the system by the process/account head.

5.3 On Bench as Process/ Voice/ Pre- Process Training Failure/ Drop-out (Should not be an OJT failure)

5.3.1 On Bench as Training Dropout or Failure will be applicable to all those employees who are either training drop out or failure and are within permissible limits of training limits. (Once in the entire tenure within DOP.

i. Communication training failures, who do not clear the voice pre-process training.

ii. Process Communication failures, who do not clear the process communication assessment at the end of the training.

iii. Process Training failures, who do not clear the domain knowledge assessment at the end of the training.

iv. Training dropouts, who could not attend the current planned training and there is no training batch planned in the current Qtr.

5.3.2 Following the communication made by HR and L1 supervisor, bench is initiated in the system by the L1 supervisor.

5.3.3 Bench letter is auto triggered once the bench is approved in the system by the process/account head.

6. Employee Responsibilities while on Bench:

Once an employee is released to bench, he or she is expected to abide by the following:

6.1 Attend the mandatory orientation session within 1 week of bench release to understand all appropriate actions and expectations while on the bench.

6.2 Attend the weekly “bench-connect” sessions scheduled with the respective Spoc.

6.3 Update the respective Spoc & HRBP immediately they are non-deployable (already allocated to another project or maternity leave, etc.)

6.4 Remain reachable over all official communication channels such as company email ID and registered phone number.

6.5 Look out for opportunities matching their profile in the Internal Job Portal (TSC- IJP) and proactively apply for them.

6.6 Attend/participate in all interviews and other deployment initiatives arranged by the Project Manager/ Delivery Manager/ Workforce Management team.

6.7 Understand that organizational opportunities per the needs of the business will take priority over the personal aspirations of employees.

6.8 Deployment location will be provided per the needs of the business and employees should have flexibility in their willingness to accept opportunities accordingly. Opportunities may be intra-city, inter-city, remotely deployed, customer location, etc.

6.9 Employees should be flexible to upskill/cross-skill given the needs of the business. Employees should be flexible to work on any shifts. Employees should not have constraints in accepting opportunities with respect to skill, technology, and domain. Employees should not have constraints to accept opportunities with respect to the role or delivery methodology.

7. Bench Consequence Management:

Bench employees who fail to adhere to any of the above guidelines will be automatically routed through consequence-management procedures. Such incidents, which can lead to an employee being cited for non-adherence or misconduct, includes:

7.1 Opportunity Rejection

- i. Failure to accept an opportunity during the profiling or interview.
- ii. Failure to accept a deployment opportunity post selection.

7.2 Opportunity Loss

- i. Failure to appear for an interview evaluation toward an opportunity to be deployed in a position.
- ii. Failure to complete an assigned skilling program or qualify for the same.
- iii. Failure to accept an opportunity basis location, process, shift, role, domain, salary, group level, etc.

7.3 No Show:

- i. Failure to be present for the bench orientation session as per the schedule.
- ii. Not being reachable over official email or registered phone number (three times on three business day).

8. Separation from Bench:

8.1 Employees who have either completed the BMP period or have failed to adhere to the guidelines as defined in section 6 -Employee Responsibilities while on Bench; all separation formalities will be implemented by the HRBP of the respective account/project.

8.2 In case of employees during bench, they will be called 3 times over a period of 3 days by the respective Spoc. In case the employee does not respond, Process Spoc/HRBP will initiate the DTS process, and a letter is sent to the employee for absconding during bench period. Employee will be terminated (as reason- absconding during bench) if they do not respond within 4 days from sent date of the letter.

9. Exception:

Any exception to the policy, extenuating situations requiring final decision will have to be recommended by BU head and approved by the DOP HR Head. The policy will be reviewed from time to time. The company, at its discretion reserves the right to amend or withdraw the policy without any notice.

AS IT IS TO BE FOLLOWED: -

- i. These reasons and their business rules are subject to change basis policy revisions within the organization that could directly / indirectly impact “on bench”.
- ii. Paid Bench redeployment/ reallocation is facilitated by DOP-WMG however, training of these resources is to be ensured by the processes.
- iii. Based on resource requirement across the processes and the profiles and its fitment DOP- WMG will then ensure that the paid bench is redeployed / reallocated with minimal delays and within SLA.

Glossary:

Term	Definition
BMP	Bench Management Policy
DTS (Disciplinary Tracking Sheet)	The form to be used by the supervisor in ensuring that due process is implemented in situations where the employee may have violated Company policies and procedures related to attendance or schedule adherence that may result in disciplinary action.
HRBP (Human Resources Business Partner)	The HRBP mapped to the respective project/ account at employee level.
Performance Coaching and Counseling Program (PCCP)	The form to be used by the supervisor in documenting the feedback on employee's performance, schedule adherence and behavior, the action plans agreed upon by the supervisor and employee, and the monitoring of the progress of action plans taken.
SIR (Security Incident Reporting)	SIR process helps in independent validation of the incident and work on correcting the underlying root cause of the issues, by reporting security incident Wipro will be in a position to contain the incident, if not already contained and take necessary corrective and preventive steps so that similar incidents do not reoccur.
SLA (Service Level Agreement)	All activities pertaining to bench management within the defined period.
Spoc	Single point of Contact for an activity.
WMG (Workforce Management Group)	The bench Spocs from WMG profiles the bench resources for open positions basis eligibility and availability.

Revision History

Version No	Change Description	Revised By	Date	Approved by
Ver 1.0	Original Document	HR		Head- HR
Ver 2.0	Version updated	HR & WMG	1-Jan-19	Head- HR
Ver 3.0	- All Contents are re-indented and aligned - S-3.10 added - S-6 added - S-7 added	HR & WMG	7-Nov-22	Head- WMG